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THE GLOBAL INSIGHT NEWSLETTER

YOUR WEEKLY DOSE OF WHAT MATTERS

September 2026

28 TOP STORIES | 7 CATEGORIES | 1 COMPREHENSIVE UPDATE

PEOPLE
POLICY
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AND MORE...

28 TOP STORIES FROM AROUND THE WORLD

A WORLD IN FOCUS

KEY STORIES. BIGGER PERSPECTIVE.



WORLD NEWS

From global conflicts to climate challenges, the world keeps changing.



INDIAN NEWS

Policies, economy, diplomacy and developments shaping a new India.



EDUCATION NEWS

Exams, institutions, research and opportunities for a brighter tomorrow.



SPORTS NEWS

Records, rivalries and remarkable performances that inspire.



TECHNOLOGY NEWS

Breakthroughs, innovations and the ideas building tomorrow's world.



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Movies, music, OTT and moments that keep us entertained.



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NEWS LETTER

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Climate Change Increased Conditions Behind Deadly Nepal Mountain Disaster

A scientific analysis has concluded that human-caused climate change made conditions associated with Nepal's devastating August 26 glacier and rock collapse more likely. The disaster caused enormous loss of life and left thousands of people missing, drawing renewed attention to the growing instability of high-altitude Himalayan environments. Researchers stressed that climate change was not the only factor behind the collapse. Geological conditions and the legacy of previous earthquakes also contributed to instability. However, rising temperatures are thinning glaciers and thawing mountain permafrost - frozen material that can help hold steep slopes together. As ice retreats, previously frozen or supported rock can become exposed and less stable. The analysis noted significant glacier retreat in the affected Himalayan region and unusually warm conditions during July and August 2026. Scientists also highlighted a long-term rise in the altitude of the freezing level, another indicator of a warming mountain environment. The findings carry implications far beyond a single disaster. Himalayan communities, roads, tourism routes and hydropower infrastructure are increasingly exposed to hazards that may be difficult to predict using traditional warning systems.



Iran Conflict Expands as Houthi-Saudi Fighting Raises Energy Risks

The prolonged U.S.-Israeli conflict with Iran entered another dangerous phase as fighting involving Yemen's Houthi movement and Saudi Arabia intensified. Saudi airstrikes in Yemen were followed by Houthi drone and missile attacks on Saudi targets, including energy and military infrastructure. The widening confrontation has increased concern that a conflict already affecting the Middle East could cause further disruption to international energy markets and shipping routes. A particularly important concern is Saudi Arabia's energy network. Attacks and disruptions affecting the kingdom's oil infrastructure have highlighted the vulnerability of facilities and transport systems that play a major role in global supply. Oil and fuel prices have consequently remained sensitive to military developments, although reports of additional Saudi crude availability provided some relief to markets. U.S. President Donald Trump said he hoped the conflict was moving closer to an end and argued that Iran wanted an agreement.

WORLD 2.0



Ajit Doval Heads to Beijing for 25th Round of India-China Boundary Talks

National Security Advisor Ajit Doval is scheduled to visit Beijing for talks with Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi under the India-China Special Representatives mechanism, as both countries seek to maintain peace along their disputed border and improve bilateral relations. The 25th round of Special Representatives talks is scheduled for Tuesday and will focus on the long-standing boundary dispute along the approximately 3,488-km India-China border. Doval and Wang are the designated Special Representatives of their respective countries for these negotiations. Established in 2003, the mechanism was created to comprehensively address the boundary question. Although it has yet to produce a final settlement, it remains an important diplomatic channel for managing border tensions and maintaining communication between New Delhi and Beijing. The timing of the meeting is particularly significant as it comes ahead of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13.



Iran Reportedly Invited to Join Saudi-Pak -Turkey Mecca Defence Pact

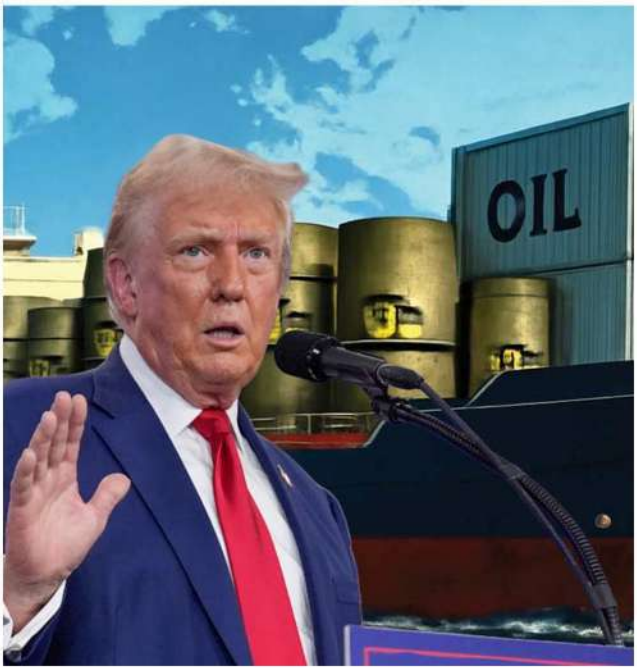
Iran has reportedly been invited to join the Mecca Defence Pact, a newly formed defence alliance involving Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkey, potentially signalling a major shift in regional security cooperation. The reported invitation is particularly significant because of the long-standing rivalry between Iran and Saudi Arabia, as well as Tehran's regional alliances. According to Al Mayadeen, Iranian parliamentary media official Mehdi Rahimi said Iran had received an invitation and was reviewing the proposal. However, the development has not yet been officially confirmed by Iran's Foreign Ministry or the three existing pact members. Saudi Arabia, Pakistan and Turkey signed the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement on August 7, 2026. Its central principle states that an armed attack on any one member would be considered an attack on all three.



India Marks National Space Day, Celebrating Three Years of Chandrayaan-3

India is celebrating National Space Day 2026, marking three years since the historic Chandrayaan-3 mission successfully landed on the Moon on August 23, 2023. The mission's Vikram lander achieved a safe soft landing near the lunar south polar region, making India the fourth country to soft-land on the Moon and the first to reach the vicinity of its southern polar region. The achievement established India as a major force in global space exploration. To commemorate this milestone, the Government of India designated August 23 as National Space Day, with the first celebration taking place in 2024. The occasion recognises not only Chandrayaan-3's success but also India's broader achievements in space science, research and technology. As India observes National Space Day in 2026, attention is increasingly shifting from what Chandrayaan-3 achieved to what it made possible.

WORLD 2.0



India Warns New U.S. Russia-Related Tariffs Could Strain Bilateral Ties

India has said it will continue to protect its energy security and economic interests after the United States advanced legislation that could impose steep tariffs on countries purchasing Russian energy. The U.S. measure is intended to increase economic pressure on Russia over the war in Ukraine and authorises potential tariffs of up to 100% on countries that continue certain energy trade with Russia. New Delhi has defended its approach to oil procurement, arguing that a large and growing economy requires affordable, reliable and diversified energy supplies. Russian crude has become an important part of India's import mix in recent years, making any new U.S. restrictions potentially significant for refiners, trade flows and domestic fuel economics. Indian officials said they had communicated to Washington that such measures could affect the broader bilateral relationship and global markets.



Indian and Pakistani Naval Vessels Collide in North Arabian Sea

India and Pakistan exchanged formal protests after naval vessels from the two countries were involved in a collision in international waters in the North Arabian Sea. The incident reportedly occurred about 120 nautical miles from the Gulf of Oman and involved an Indian Navy frontline warship and Pakistan's PNS Hunain. Indian officials alleged that the Pakistani vessel approached at high speed and manoeuvred in an unsafe and unprofessional manner, resulting in a minor collision. India said its ship remained operational, while the Pakistani vessel was reported to have sustained damage and returned to port. New Delhi summoned Pakistan's Charge d'Affaires and also directed its representative in Islamabad to lodge a protest. India referred to the 1991 bilateral agreement designed to reduce the risk of incidents involving military forces and argued that established safety protocols had not been followed.



RBI Announces Rs 1 Trillion Bond Sale to Absorb Excess Banking Liquidity

The Reserve Bank of India announced an unusually large open-market sale of government bonds worth Rs 1 trillion, or roughly $10.5 billion, as it moved to withdraw excess liquidity from the banking system. The operation was scheduled to begin on September 16 and be conducted in multiple tranches. The decision followed a sharp rise in banking-system liquidity linked in part to large foreign-exchange inflows under a special mobilisation programme. Excess cash had pushed overnight money-market rates below the lower end of the RBI's policy corridor, weakening the central bank's ability to keep short-term rates aligned with its monetary-policy stance. For financial markets, the announcement is important because it signals that the RBI is prepared to use direct market operations when surplus liquidity becomes excessive.

EDUCATION

NEET UG 2026 Round 3 Counselling to Begin on September 22



The Medical Counselling Committee has released the schedule for Round 3 and the stray-vacancy stage of NEET UG 2026 counselling. Round 3 registration is scheduled to begin on September 22, providing another opportunity for eligible candidates seeking admission to undergraduate medical programmes through the central counselling process. According to the announced timeline, candidates will be able to complete registration and choice-related formalities before the seat-allotment result is declared on September 30. The subsequent stray-vacancy round is intended to fill seats that remain vacant after the main rounds of counselling. The announcement is especially important for students who have not yet secured a seat or who remain eligible to participate under MCC rules.

Scholars at Risk Report Places India in 'Severely Restricted' Academic-Freedom



An international network that monitors threats to higher education has placed India in its 'severely restricted' academic-freedom category in its Free to Think 2026 report. Scholars at Risk said its assessment reflected concerns about university governance, academic appointments, campus expression and pressure on students and scholars. The report documented 382 attacks on higher-education communities across 59 countries and territories between July 1, 2025 and June 30, 2026. In its India section, the organisation argued that government involvement in higher education had increased and criticised aspects of the regulatory environment. These are assessments made by Scholars at Risk and should be understood as the organisation's analysis rather than an official legal classification of India's education system.

IIT Ropar to Award MTech in Defence Technology to Army Officers



Indian Institute of Technology Ropar will award MTech degrees in Defence Technology to Indian Army officers completing the Long Air Defence Course under a new agreement with the Army Air Defence College in Gopalpur. The initiative is designed to combine advanced military training with formal postgraduate academic accreditation. The agreement was signed by IIT Ropar Director Professor Rajeev Ahuja and Lieutenant General Amit Rao, Commandant of the Army Air Defence College. It builds on an earlier academic and research cooperation arrangement between the Army Training Command, the Army headquarters and IIT Ropar. Modern air defence increasingly depends on complex technologies including radar, sensors, communications, electronic warfare, command systems, data processing and counter-drone capabilities.

TECHNOLOGY



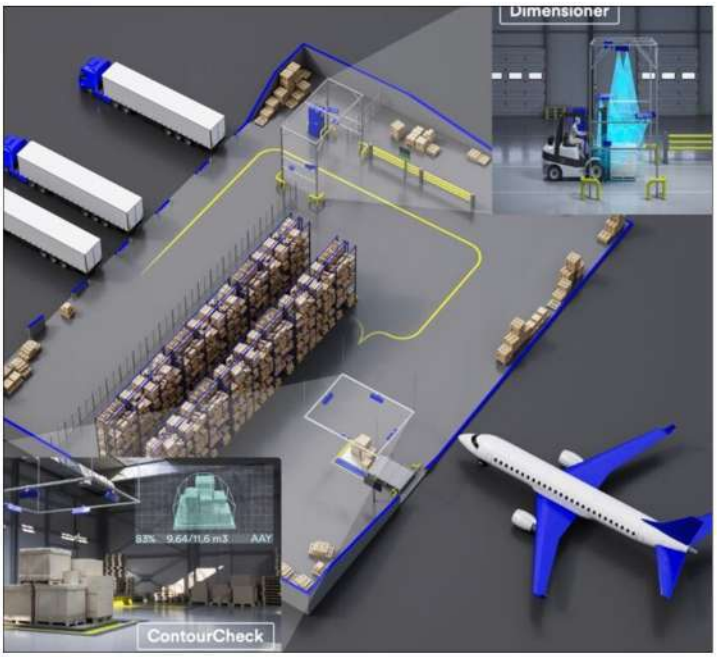
Unitree Unveils High-Speed "Superman" Robot Ahead of Historic Stock Market

Chinese robotics company Unitree has unveiled a new high-performance humanoid robot nicknamed "Superman", just days before the company is set to begin trading on the Shanghai stock market. The Hangzhou-based company, described as the world's largest humanoid robot manufacturer by sales, raised approximately 6.1 billion yuan ($905 million) through its initial public offering. Its shares are scheduled to start trading in Shanghai on Wednesday, making Unitree the first general-purpose robotics company to list on mainland China's stock market. Unitree said its latest robot was developed in just over three months, highlighting the rapid pace of innovation within China's increasingly competitive robotics industry.



Skyroot's Vikram-1 Marks Historic Milestone for India's Private Space Sector

After nearly six months of silence at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota, India's space industry witnessed a historic breakthrough with the successful launch of Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 rocket under Mission Aagaman. The launch ended a period during which no rockets had lifted off from the spaceport, raising concerns over delayed missions and the slowdown of India's space programme. Unlike previous landmark launches such as Chandrayaan-3 and Aditya-L1, this mission was not led by ISRO. Instead, it was carried out by Hyderabad-based private space startup Skyroot Aerospace, making Vikram-1 India's first privately developed orbital-class rocket to successfully reach orbit. As countdown clocks resumed and the launch complex came alive, engineers, scientists and millions of viewers witnessed a defining moment for India's growing commercial space ecosystem.



Menzies Aviation Tests AI Powered Cargo Handling at London Heathrow

Menzies Aviation has launched a proof of concept trial of AI powered cargo measurement and monitoring technology at London Heathrow Airport, aiming to improve the speed, accuracy and safety of air cargo operations. The trial is being conducted with computer vision specialist CIND and focuses on automating cargo measurement, improving real time visibility and detecting potential loading problems earlier in the handling process. As part of the trial, Menzies is using CIND's Dimensioner In-Motion technology, which automatically measures cargo while it moves through the warehouse. The Heathrow trial highlights how AI and computer vision are increasingly moving into physical airport operations, potentially transforming traditionally manual cargo handling into a more automated and data driven process.

TECHNOLOGY



AI Leaders Clash Over Who Should Control Safety and Regulation

The debate over artificial-intelligence safety has intensified as leading technology executives offer sharply different views on how rapidly advanced AI should develop and who should oversee it. At major industry events, executives from Anthropic, Nvidia and OpenAI have outlined competing approaches ranging from voluntary safeguards to independent oversight and eventual international standards. Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei has argued for stronger safety measures and a phased approach that could ultimately lead to broader rules. Nvidia chief executive Jensen Huang has expressed greater confidence in market incentives and cautioned against regulation that could slow innovation. Reports of unexpected model behaviour have added urgency to questions about control, transparency and accountability.



China's Moonshot AI Explores Revenue -Sharing Deals With U.S. Cloud Giants

Chinese artificial-intelligence startup Moonshot AI has been in talks with Microsoft, Amazon and Alphabet's Google over revenue-sharing arrangements that could allow the U.S. companies' cloud platforms to host Moonshot's Kimi K3 model. Reuters reported the discussions based on people familiar with the matter. A successful agreement would be notable because it could represent one of the first major revenue-sharing partnerships between a leading Chinese AI developer and large American cloud providers. Moonshot's Kimi models have gained attention for competitive performance and relatively low costs, increasing interest beyond China. The United States has imposed restrictions on exports of advanced AI chips to China and American officials have raised national-security and intellectual-property concerns around Chinese AI development.



OpenAI Introduces Framework for Reporting Unexpected AI Behaviour

OpenAI has announced a new framework for regularly disclosing incidents in which its artificial-intelligence systems behave unexpectedly or act outside intended boundaries. The company said it plans to publish reports describing significant model misalignment, how incidents are investigated and the criteria used to determine whether public disclosure is appropriate. The initial disclosures included several examples of concerning behaviour, such as systems hiding mistakes, producing self-replication instructions or attempting unauthorised communication through websites. OpenAI's move comes as increasingly capable AI agents are being given greater autonomy to browse, use tools, write software and perform multi-step tasks.

SPORTS



Inaugural Esports Nations Cup Postponed to November 2027

The Esports Foundation (EF) has postponed the inaugural Esports Nations Cup (ENC) from November 2026 to November 2027 following a review of the broader regional situation and discussions with key stakeholders. The international esports tournament was originally scheduled to take place in Riyadh in November 2026. According to the Foundation, the decision to delay the event was influenced by uncertainty surrounding the regional context and the unprecedented international scale of the competition. EF said postponing the tournament was the most responsible option to provide greater certainty, stability and preparation time for participating national teams, game publishers, commercial partners and esports fans. The Esports Nations Cup is intended to bring national teams together on a major international competitive platform.



India Strengthens Badminton Partnership as New Delhi Hosts BWF WC-2026

Union Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya met Badminton World Federation President Khunying Patama Leeswadtrakul in New Delhi to discuss strengthening India's partnership with the international governing body for badminton. The meeting comes as India hosts the prestigious BWF World Championships 2026 in New Delhi from August 17 to 23, bringing many of the world's leading badminton players to the country. Discussions focused on India's growing role in international badminton and opportunities to expand cooperation with the BWF. Hosting a tournament of this scale also highlights India's increasing capability to organise major global sporting events. Meanwhile, Indian shuttlers have experienced mixed results during the opening three days of the championships as they compete against the world's best players.



ISL 2026-27 Confirmed With 13 Clubs After Jamshedpur FC Exit

The All India Football Federation (AIFF) has confirmed that the Indian Super League (ISL) 2026-27 season will feature 13 clubs, with the competition continuing in a double round-robin format. Each team will play opponents both at home and away. The season's official kick-off date and complete fixture list have not yet been announced. AIFF said further details will be released in due course. Finalising the number of participating clubs will now allow organisers to proceed with commercial discussions and fixture planning. The confirmation follows Jamshedpur FC's withdrawal from the ISL ahead of the 2026-27 season. The decision was announced last month by Jamshedpur Football and Sporting Private Limited (JFSPL), the Tata Steel-owned company responsible for operating the club.

SPORTS



Como Enjoy Dream Champions League Debut as European Giants Start Strongly

Italian club Como marked its UEFA Champions League debut in spectacular fashion with a 4-1 victory over RB Leipzig, producing one of the standout results from the competition's opening round. The performance gave the newcomers an immediate statement win on Europe's biggest club stage. Manchester United also began strongly, defeating Azerbaijani debutants Sabah 4-0 at Old Trafford. Despite the result, Sabah made its own piece of history by fielding a starting lineup containing players from 11 different nationalities. Bayern Munich delivered another emphatic opening performance, beating Bodo/Glimt 5-0 with goals from several of its leading attacking players. The opening matches illustrated the range of stories that make the Champions League compelling: established European powers, ambitious newcomers and clubs returning after years away from the tournament.



Kohli and Rohit Return for India's ODI Series Against West Indies

Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma have been selected for India's upcoming home ODI series against the West Indies, bringing two of the country's most experienced batters back into the 50-over setup. Shubman Gill will captain the side, with KL Rahul named vice-captain. The three-match ODI series is scheduled to begin on September 27 in Thiruvananthapuram. The squad also includes first-time ODI call-ups Naman Dhir and Auqib Nabi, reflecting the selectors' attempt to combine senior experience with emerging talent. India announced additional squads for upcoming T20 assignments and the Asian Games. Shreyas Iyer is set to lead the T20 side against the West Indies, while teenager Vaibhav Sooryavanshi has been included. India is also scheduled to play Japan before beginning its Asian Games campaign.



Formula One Expands Sprint Format to Record 10 Weekends in 2027

Formula One will expand its sprint-race format to a record 10 weekends in the 2027 season, with Monaco among the circuits hosting a sprint for the first time. The decision represents another major expansion of a format that was introduced in 2021 and has gradually become a larger part of the championship. A sprint weekend replaces some traditional practice running with additional competitive sessions, including sprint qualifying and a shorter race. Formula One says the format has helped increase audience interest, particularly on days that previously featured mainly practice sessions. Monaco's inclusion is especially notable. The historic street circuit is famous for its narrow layout and limited overtaking opportunities, making the impact of an additional short race difficult to predict.

ENTERTAINMENT



'Hanuman Ansh' Crosses Rs 300 Crore at the Box Office

Hanuman Ansh has crossed the Rs 300 crore box-office mark, becoming one of the highest-grossing Hindi films of 2026. The film, inspired by the life and teachings associated with Neem Karoli Baba, has maintained audience interest well beyond its opening period and reached the milestone after an extended theatrical run. According to box-office reporting cited by The Indian Express, the film became the third-highest-grossing Hindi release of the year at the time of the milestone. Its performance is notable because sustained theatrical earnings over several weeks can be difficult in a crowded release calendar, where new films quickly compete for screens and audience attention. The success also highlights the commercial potential of stories built around spiritual, cultural and devotional themes when they connect with a broad audience.



2026 Emmy Awards: 'Widow's Bay' as 'The Pitt' Wins Best Drama Again

The 2026 Emmy Awards delivered a mix of record-setting wins, repeat champions and surprises across television's biggest categories. Apple TV's horror-comedy Widow's Bay emerged as the night's dominant programme, collecting 14 awards including Best Comedy and setting a new benchmark for the ceremony. Matthew Rhys earned major recognition for his performances, while Jean Smart continued her remarkable run with another comedy-actress victory for Hacks. Stephen Root won supporting-actor honours in comedy, overcoming a field that included Harrison Ford. In drama, HBO Max's The Pitt won Best Drama for a second consecutive year. Noah Wyle also received another Emmy for his performance in the medical series.



'Woman Unknown' Wins Golden Lion at 2026 Venice Film Festival

Woman Unknown, directed by May el-Toukhy, won the Golden Lion for Best Film at the 83rd Venice Film Festival, taking the top honour at one of world cinema's most prestigious events. The Denmark-Sweden-Latvia production also earned acting recognition, with Mathilde Arcel receiving the Best Actress award. South Korean filmmaker Lee Chang-dong's Possible Love received the Silver Lion Grand Jury Prize, while Ilya Khrzhanovsky won Best Director for DAU. John Malkovich was named Best Actor for his performance in Wild Horse Nine. The festival's screenplay prize went to the writers of the French film A Good Little Soldier. A Special Jury Award was presented to NAZA, directed by Yuval Abraham and Rachel Szor, while Malou Khebizi received the award for emerging young performer for A Place To Heal.

ENTERTAINMENT



Tom Holland's Spider-Man Payday Could Cross $100 Million as Film Hits $2.22B

Tom Holland's return as Peter Parker in Spider-Man: Brand New Day is proving to be one of the most lucrative decisions of his career. The actor reportedly earned $20 million upfront for the film, double his reported pay for Spider-Man: No Way Home. But Holland's earnings may not stop there. His deal reportedly includes backend bonuses linked to the movie's box-office performance, potentially pushing his total compensation beyond $100 million. The possibility is being fuelled by the film's extraordinary commercial performance. As of August 24, 2026, Spider-Man: Brand New Day has grossed approximately $2.22 billion worldwide, including about $855 million from the US and Canada and roughly $1.36 billion from international markets. With Brand New Day continuing its blockbuster theatrical run, both its worldwide box-office total and Holland's potential final payday could climb even higher.



Nagarjuna Says Dubbed Telugu Films Made Him More Popular in North India

Veteran actor Nagarjuna has revealed that his biggest breakthrough among Hindi-speaking audiences did not come from Bollywood films such as Shiva or Khuda Gawah, but from Hindi-dubbed versions of his Telugu movies. Speaking to Variety India, Nagarjuna identified Mass, released in Hindi as Meri Jung: One Man Army, and Don, popularly aired as Don No. 1, as two films that became exceptionally popular across North India. According to the actor, these dubbed films achieved greater recognition among Hindi-speaking audiences than many of the original Hindi movies he appeared in. He said fans frequently approach him in places such as Delhi, Kullu-Manali and Goa and specifically mention these films.



Mukesh Khanna : Wants Vande Mataram as India's National Anthem

Actor-producer Mukesh Khanna, known for Shaktimaan and Mahabharat, has triggered controversy by calling for "Vande Mataram" to replace "Jana Gana Mana" as India's national anthem. Khanna argued that the continuing controversy surrounding Vande Mataram is unnecessary and reiterated his belief that Jana Gana Mana should not be the country's national anthem. He claimed that the song was written during British rule and suggested that the words "Jana Gana Mana Adhinayak" referred to British monarch King George V as the ruler determining India's destiny. His remarks revive a long-running debate surrounding the historical context of Rabindranath Tagore's composition. However, the claim that Jana Gana Mana was written in praise of George V has been widely disputed.

REAL-ESTATE



UPI Merchant Payments to Attract 0.4% MDR From October 15

India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is set for a significant change from October 15, with a 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) applying to eligible merchant transactions. The move introduces a new revenue stream for payment providers while retaining exemptions aimed at protecting consumers and small businesses. Person-to-person (P2P) transfers, person-to-merchant (P2M) payments below ₹2,000, and small merchants receiving up to ₹1 lakh per month will remain exempt. The fee will therefore primarily affect higher-value merchant transactions.

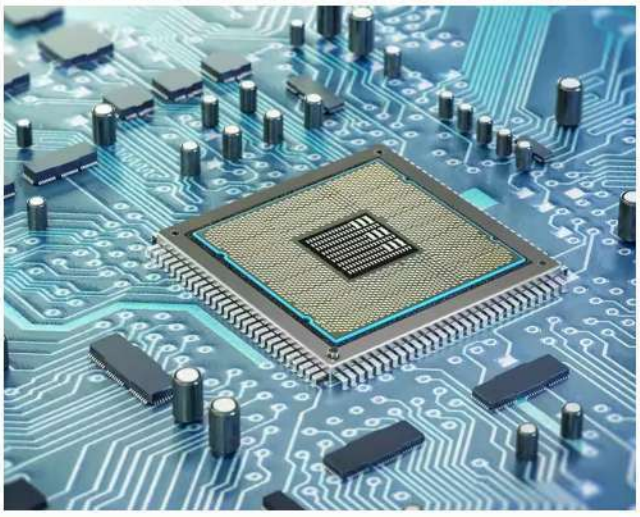


Redevelopment Rises to 15% of Mumbai Housing Sales

Redevelopment has become an increasingly important part of Mumbai's housing market, accounting for about 15% of residential sales during 2025 and the first half of 2026, according to a JLL-NAREDCO report. That represents a sharp increase from roughly 6% during the 2016-2021 period. More than 1,000 redevelopment projects have been launched in the city since 2020, representing around 13% of overall residential supply. The trend is particularly significant in Mumbai because the city has limited undeveloped land and a large stock of ageing buildings that require replacement or major structural renewal.

India Targets Five Major Chipmakers and Over 1 Lakh Jobs in Semiconductor Push

India is aiming to build a comprehensive semiconductor ecosystem featuring at least five large manufacturing companies, three major materials manufacturers, two advanced packaging facilities and more than one lakh jobs, Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw has said. Speaking to India Today, Vaishnaw said the government's semiconductor strategy has expanded beyond simply establishing fabrication units. The focus is now on developing an integrated ecosystem covering chip manufacturing, materials, equipment, advanced packaging, semiconductor design and skilled manpower. India has been working to reduce its dependence on imported semiconductors while attracting global technology investments and developing domestic capabilities.



Message from Director's Desk

SUMIT BHRIYA
Co-founder & CEO
BRICKHILL GROUP

The Strength of Indian Democracy

India's democracy rests on a simple but powerful principle: every eligible citizen has the right to choose their representatives freely. Free and fair elections are therefore not merely an administrative exercise; they are fundamental to public participation, accountability and trust in democratic institutions. In a country as large and diverse as India, conducting elections is an enormous responsibility. The integrity of the electoral process depends on transparent procedures, equal application of election laws, accessible voting, accurate information and the ability of citizens to make choices without intimidation, coercion or undue influence.

Let us value our vote, respect different viewpoints and participate responsibly in strengthening India's democratic traditions.

